

University of Michigan

Winter 2024 Midterm Instructor Report

EECS 592-001: AI Foundations

Madelyn Gatchel

55 out of 56 students responded to this midterm evaluation.

Responses to questions related to the course:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
I am learning a great deal in this course. (Q966)	14	25	10	6	0	0	3.96

Responses to questions related to the instructor:

	SA	A	N	D	SD	N/A	Median
Madelyn Gatchel is enthusiastic. (Q114)	36	17	1	0	0	0	4.75
Overall, this is an excellent course. (Q964)	21	20	9	3	1	0	4.20
Overall, Madelyn Gatchel is an excellent teacher. (Q965)	30	20	4	0	0	0	4.60
Madelyn Gatchel acknowledges all questions insofar as possible. (Q968)	36	17	0	0	0	1	4.76
Madelyn Gatchel uses techniques to foster class participation. (Q972)	31	14	7	0	0	2	4.66
Madelyn Gatchel is willing to meet and help students outside class. (Q975)	33	18	0	0	0	3	4.73
Madelyn Gatchel keeps students informed of their progress. (Q977)	27	17	7	0	0	2	4.56

Written Comments

What are the major strengths of this class? What is helping you to learn? (Q979)

Comments
The staff is a major strength of this course. Madelyn and Vicente are always willing to help students with their questions and guide us through misunderstandings. I especially love office hours for this reason. Additionally, Professor is very enthusiastic about the material and does a good job of switching up class activities to keep things interesting.
The teacher helps to get us famaliar with how to conduct real research with great schedule. She encourages students to talk about thier proposals and ideas with the teacher and GSIs after classes. The class involves multi aspects of Artificial Intelligence, which broaden my view. It fosters our teamwork competence by randomly forming teams and encourages us to communicate.
The homework is really good — the questions help students develop a more rigorous understanding of the course content.
It is well structured.
Good overview of all topics
Discussion sections are really nice for review; well organized and good practice
Good class for start learning what is AI and the basic ideas.
The discussion includes examples to help students understand and apply the lecture material.
The textbook is well-written and a helpful guide into this material. The homework 1 helped me learned the material, more than the class lectures so far.
It is helping me learn the material in the AI textbook. Clear grading rubrics
The course is well organized, and I don't feel like there is really any confusion regarding expectations of me.
Discussions
The major strengths are the lectures and lecture slides; both are very detailed and give us all that we need to do well on the homeworks. I also find that having sample problems that reinforce topics taught in the previous lecture really help with honing down on some complex algorithms and ideas. Discussion practice problem slides are also good.
I like the numerical examples given in lecture and discussion. They help me to understand the application of certain topics.
Lecture/discussion examples! Most of them have been very helpful for the homework. It's nice to have examples that are relevant to the questions we have to work on.
Lectures are very engaging.
The detailed examples we go through in both lectures and discussions really helped me grasp new concepts.
Homework and the final project are good, helping us understand and apply the methods covered in this course. Also, I think the textbook is awesome!
I felt that the homework allowed me to adequately practice the material covered in class, although some of the wording was a bit unclear (especially for the CSP problem) which made it kind of hard sometimes. However, the search problem, programming problem, and logic problem was pretty good.
The content and the book have been great, and I appreciate the emphasis on keeping up with the readings alongside class.
Textbook is great, I learn everything from there.
Open to questions. Very interactive (not just in lectures, but we all feel encouraged to reach out to the teaching team).
Working through examples, showing multiple ways of demonstration which helps solidify understanding.
The content of the course is very interesting and useful. The lecture and discussion slides are helpful. ChatGPT and Google also helps when I am confused.
I like the topics covered in this class, they are fun and helpful to learn about. Going through examples in class is helpful to understand the concepts.
I like that we have a period of time to finish the homework and project.
The class is relatively small in size which I like.

How can Madelyn Gatchel improve this class? If possible, give specific examples. (Q980)

Comments
She could be more confident and talk more fluently, since she is a really brilliant GSI.
N/A
Providing the slides during discussion with the all the answers and steps for each question.
It is clear Madelyn wants to provide good instruction as a GSI and she puts in a lot of effort during office hours answering everyone's questions.
Madelyn sometimes gets stuck when asked to provide an example of how a concept works, such as constraint satisfaction problems. She often doesn't want to use the example provided in the homework questions, understandably so. To improve, perhaps the GSIs should have an example set of questions modeled off the homework, so the GSIs can explain the more difficult questions by walking us through a practice question.
More clear instructions on PSETs
nothing
Checking some discrepancies between homework problems, lecture slides, and the book can reduce some confusion. Also, there are frequent errors in discussion slides that cause confusion, so please review them beforehand.
N/A
Madelyn did a great job leading the discussion, where she actively involves everyone to participate in solving example questions.
Madelyn has been great
Improve the grade scope grading for assignments with hidden tests
N/A
n/a
Probably try to cover more examples in discussions, and explain each of them slightly slower. I feel like discussions go over some examples too fast :(
she is a great instructor!

Please enter any additional comments you have for Madelyn Gatchel. (Q981)

Comments
N/A.
N/A
Madelyn providing worked out examples on Piazza has been very useful.
Enthusiastic
none
None
Madelyn is awesome! She helped my group and I land on a research project, and she gives great advice in office hours. She's fun to listen to in discussion as she's enthusiastic and knowledgeable.
N/A
N/A
N/A
I appreciate Madelyn's willingness to help with understanding various problems
Thank you for a great class!
Madelyn is very enthusiastic!